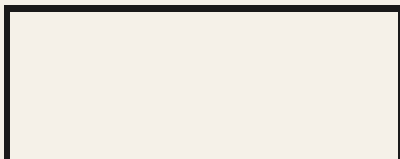


SACKING THE MANAGER DOESN'T WORK THE WAY YOU THINK



■ THE NUMBER EVERYONE BELIEVES



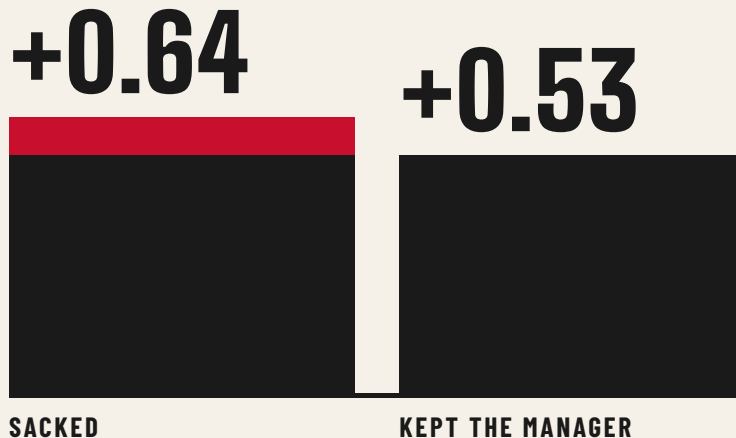
+0.64

Points-per-game improvement in the 10 games
after a manager is sacked

This is the number that gets cited. It's also misleading.

WHAT THAT NUMBER HIDES

Both groups were club-seasons in an identical slump. The only difference: whether the manager was changed.



Struggling teams recover either way. Most of the 'bounce' isn't the new manager.

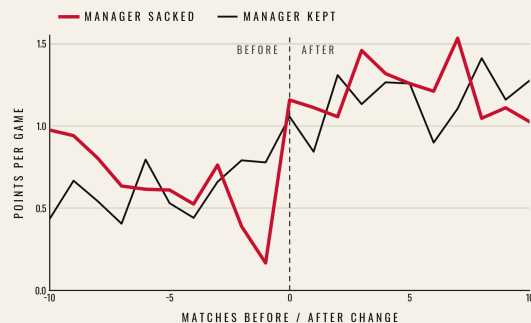
■ THE REAL NUMBER

+0.12

The actual gap attributable to sacking the manager — and it's not statistically significant

108 MATCHED CASES. $P = 0.06$.

THE BOUNCE IS AN ILLUSION OF TIMING



Clubs are sacked at their lowest point — so results can only climb from there. The clubs that kept their manager climbed just as much. The rebound is regression to the mean, not the new boss.

■ THE METHOD

154

In-season manager changes detected — Bundesliga, 2012-2025.

108 met the slump + matching criteria and were actually analyzed.

Matched comparison + regression analysis.

- Robustness check: a shorter 5-match window shows a larger gap of +0.23 ($p = 0.005$).

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